

FILE F-1

CONTROL & OPERATIONS

Three documents. They are yours. Nobody else may read them until the Conference ends.

DOC	TITLE
C-1	Statement — H. Vey, Shift Control Engineer
C-5	Statement — C. Mbeki, Assistant Operator
D-1A	Console 1 — operator session record

Your brief. You speak for the control room. You know what an operator does during a storm, what the console records, and what it does not. When somebody at this table says "he was at his desk all night," you are the one who can say what that claim actually rests on.

H. VEY — SHIFT CONTROL ENGINEER

INTERVIEWEE	VEY, H. (47)	DATE	19 NOV, 16:20	STATUS	WITNESS
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DS Take me through the night.

HV I took console at ten. Bettany was already on us. During a storm you don't leave the desk — the alarms come in threes and fours and you're acknowledging, you're watching levels, you're deciding whether to pass water. I was at console one from twenty-two hundred until Cato came running in at ten past six.

DS Continuously?

HV Continuously. That's the job.

DS You opened intake gate 2 at half past two.

HV I did. Inflow was up to a hundred and twenty-six and climbing and I wanted to take the top off before the peak came through. Forty minutes of gate two, then I shut it. You'll find that's textbook and you'll find the Inspectorate said so.

DS Tell me about Ines Ballard.

HV Ines was the best engineer on this station and I'd say that to anyone. She was also somebody who got hold of a thing and would not put it down. She'd got hold of the foundation piezometers — said the numbers weren't moving with the reservoir. I said, it's a storm, look at it Thursday.

DS Did she look at it Thursday?

[Pause.]

HV No. She went down the gallery with Aurelio at about ten past two.

DS And then?

HV And then there was an argument. Twenty-five past two, in the corridor. Raised voices, the pair of them. I stayed at my desk. It isn't my place and I had a storm on.

DS Did you see either of them after that?

HV Aurelio, at twenty to six. He came in and I told him Ines had gone off somewhere and that C-14 was throwing an earth fault on F-5. He said he'd look at it. That's the last thing I said to him.

DS Where was Ms Ballard?

HV I assumed the site office. She wanted the as-builts. I thought she'd gone to dig them out and stew about it, frankly.

DS Her card opened C-14 at quarter to six.

HV Then she was there, wasn't she.

[Interviewee becomes distressed. Break taken 16:51-17:04.]

HV Forty-one years old. I have known her since she was a graduate. Whatever she did, I would like somebody to remember that.

C. MBEKI — ASSISTANT OPERATOR

INTERVIEWEE	MBEKI, C. (26)	DATE	19 NOV, 13:05	STATUS	WITNESS — FOUND
					DECEASED 1

DS Where were you?

CM Downstream powerhouse. Nine hours. Aurelio put me over there at nine to babysit the number two set — it was hunting on load and somebody had to sit with it through the storm. You can't leave a machine like that on its own.

DS Nine hours alone.

CM Across a footbridge, in a gale, at night, on my own, yes. It was the worst night of my life and then it got worse.

DS Did you cross back at any point before six?

CM No. You badge the footbridge door both ways, it's all on the system. I crossed at four minutes past nine and I crossed back at five past six.

DS Tell me about six.

CM The set tripped. Whole board went. I crossed back and went up to the turbine hall because that's where the fault was showing, and he was —

[Pause.]

CM He was on the floor by C-14. His lock was still on the F-5 isolator. I want to say that because people are saying he was careless and he wasn't. His padlock was on. He'd tested it. He did it right.

DS You held a spare control room key.

CM In September, for two weeks, when the lock was changed. I gave it back. It's in the register.

DS Anything else?

CM Only that Ines was fine. People keep asking me if she seemed like somebody who — and she was fine. She was cross about the piezometers. Being cross about instruments is not the same as anything else and I wish somebody would write that down.

[Recorded as stated.]

CONSOLE 1 — SESSION RECORD, 18-19 NOVEMBER

Operator logged on	H.VEY, 18 NOV 21:58:11
Operator logged off	19 NOV 07:41:02
Session interruptions	NONE
Second operator logged on at console 1	NONE
Console lock events	NONE
Console 2 (backup) session	NOT LOGGED ON AT ANY TIME

A single unbroken operator session of nine hours and forty-three minutes. No other operator logged on to console 1 or console 2 at any point that night. Every control action taken at console 1 during the storm was taken inside this session.

CONTROL ACTIONS TAKEN AT CONSOLE 1

TIME	ACTION
22:14	Unit 1 load setpoint adjusted
23:40	Unit 2 governor droop adjusted
01:05	Unit 1 load setpoint adjusted
02:31	Intake gate 2 — OPEN
03:12	Intake gate 2 — CLOSED
04:20	Unit 2 load setpoint adjusted
06:02	Feeder F-3 tie — CLOSED (credential I.BALLARD)

NOTE ON CREDENTIALS AT A CONSOLE

A logged-on operator session and a credentialled control action are separate records. The session says who is *signed in*. A control action on a permissioned circuit additionally requires a card to be presented at the console reader at the moment of the action. **The two need not be the same person, and the system does not require them to be.**

Operations note: this record shows only that the session was open. It does not, and cannot, show whether the operator was in the chair.

FILE F-2

HYDROLOGY & RECOVERY

Three documents. They are yours. Nobody else may read them until the Conference ends.

DOC	TITLE
D-2	Recovery report — I. Ballard
D-2A	Intake gallery — hydrological statement & section
D-2B	Forebay and gallery — flow conditions

Your brief. You speak for the water. The Inspectorate's referral note on the Case Board asks one question and it is your question: **how did she get in there?** Nobody else at this table can answer it. Decide when to.

RECOVERY — I. BALLARD, INTAKE GALLERY

LOCATED	19 NOV 07:25	RECOVERED	19 NOV 09:14	OFFICER	SGT A. LINDQVIST
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LOCATION

Structure	INTAKE GALLERY (SEALED)
Position	TRASH RACK PANEL 4
Elevation of body	218.4 m AOD
Relative to intake gate 2	DOWNSTREAM
Gallery condition on entry	DRY ABOVE SILL (211.0 m)

NARRATIVE

Search of the forebay by boat and pole was negative from first light. At 07:25 the gallery was entered through the upstream inspection hatch on the instruction of the duty civil engineer, who observed that if the deceased were not in open water she could only be against the racks.

The deceased was found on the upstream face of trash rack panel 4, in a semi-prone position, held against the bars by nothing but her own weight and the shape of the panel. The gallery was dry above the sill and she was not in water at the time of recovery.

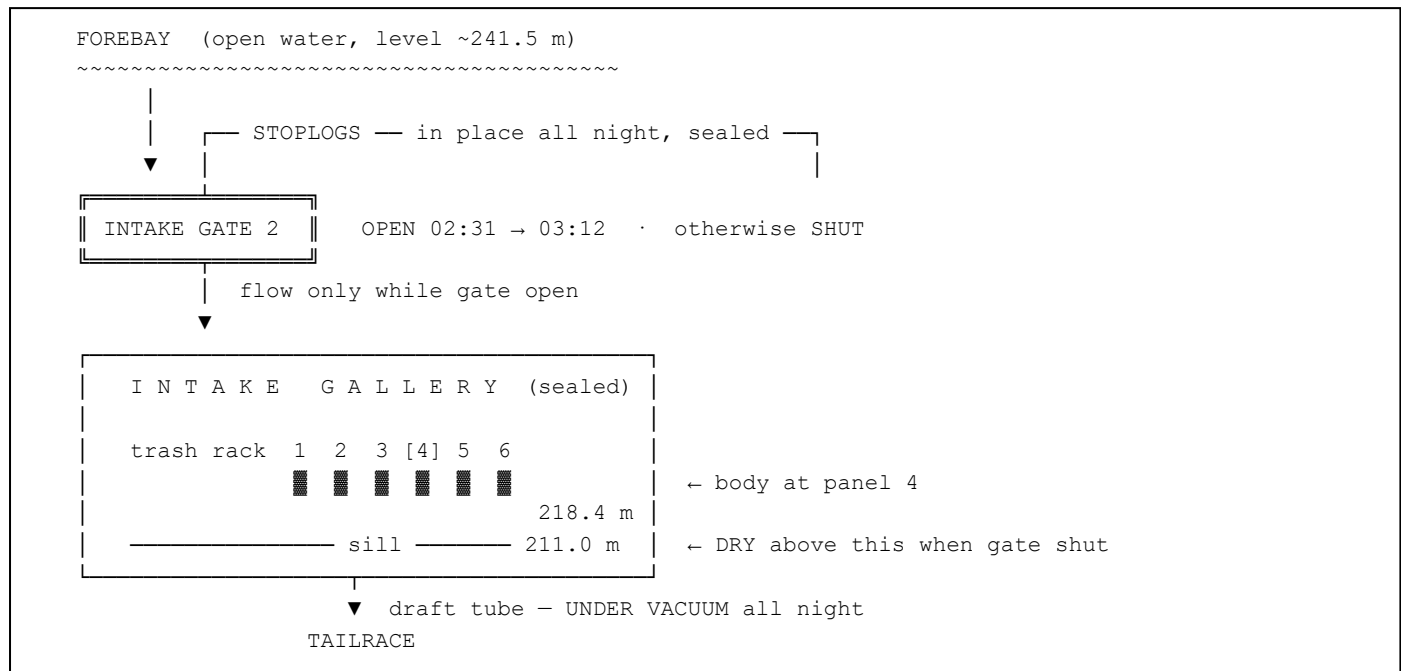
The deceased lay beneath a consolidated mat of storm debris — bracken, spruce needles, and a length of fence rail — packed hard against the rack and extending across panels 3 to 5. The mat was cut away to reach her. Approximately 40 kg of material was removed.

The Unit does not offer an opinion on when this material arrived. Cairnhold civil hold the rack differential-pressure trace, from which the question can be answered.

OBSERVATIONS

- Clothing intact, boots laced, hi-vis fastened. No sign of preparation to enter water.
- A permanent marker was still clipped in the chest pocket.
- **No credential card and no lanyard on the body or in any pocket.**
- Wristwatch stopped. Face broken by rack contact. The Unit places no weight on the stopped time and has not recorded it, immersion having continued long after the impact.

HOW WATER — AND ANYTHING IN IT — REACHES PANEL 4



STATEMENT

1. **The gallery is sealed.** There are three openings: intake gate 2, the upstream inspection hatch, and the draft tube. There are no others.
2. **The inspection hatch was dogged shut** from the storm preparation on 18 November at 16:40 until it was opened by the recovery team at 07:25 on 19 November. It is bolted from outside. It cannot be opened from within the gallery.
3. **The draft tube ran under vacuum** continuously while unit 1 was generating, which it was all night without interruption. Flow through the draft tube is *outward and downward* at all times. Nothing enters the gallery this way. Nothing can.
4. **The upstream stoplogs were in place** and sealed for the duration of the storm, as logged in the storm-preparation checklist.
5. **Therefore the only route from the forebay to trash rack panel 4 is through intake gate 2, while intake gate 2 is open and flowing.**
6. **Whenever intake gate 2 is shut, the gallery is dry above the sill at 211.0 m.** The body was at 218.4 m — seven metres above the sill. There is no standing water at that elevation with the gate shut. There is nothing there at all.

Conclusion of this statement. The deceased passed through intake gate 2 while it was open and flowing. Cairnhold Civil offers no view on how she came to be in the forebay. We say only that she was carried into the gallery by water, and that the water was only there for as long as the gate was.

SIGNED

T. ARGYLE, PRINCIPAL CIVIL ENGR

DATE

02 DEC

TRANSIT AND RETENTION

TRANSIT

Forebay surface to intake gate 2 mouth	~40 m
Surface velocity toward the intake, gate 2 open	0.6-0.9 m/s
Approximate transit, parapet to rack	2 to 4 minutes
Transit with gate 2 shut	NO FLOW — NO TRANSIT

A body entering the forebay near the parapet while gate 2 is open will be drawn to the racks within a few minutes. The intake draws from the surface layer during a spill of this magnitude, and floating objects are recovered from the racks routinely after every storm.

RETENTION

Once flow ceases, an object on the racks stays on the racks. There is no mechanism to move it. The gallery is dry, still and enclosed. This is why the racks must be raked by hand after every significant event.

RAKE RECORD — TRASH RACK, INTAKE GALLERY

DATE	PANELS RAKED	RECOVERED	BY
02 NOV	1-6	Vegetation, 60 kg. Nothing else.	D. Okonkwo
17 NOV	1-6	Vegetation, 20 kg. Racks left clear.	D. Okonkwo
19 NOV	—	Recovery operation. See D-2.	

The racks were raked clear on 17 November, the day before the storm. Everything found on them on 19 November arrived during Storm Bettany.

Cairnhold Civil holds a continuous **differential-pressure trace** across the racks. Debris loading is directly readable from it, including the moment any significant mat formed. It is not reproduced here.

FILE F-3

MECHANICAL & MAINTENANCE

Three documents. They are yours. Nobody else may read them until the Conference ends.

DOC	TITLE
C-3	Statement — D. Okonkwo, Mechanical Maintenance Technician
C-3A	Confined space permits & atmospheric monitor telemetry
E-6	Cabinet C-14 — plant report & isolation procedure

Your brief. You speak for the plant and the people who work on it. You are the only person at this table who can explain what a lockout actually is, and therefore the only one who can say why a man who did everything right is dead.

D. OKONKWO — MECHANICAL MAINTENANCE TECHNICIAN

INTERVIEWEE	OKONKWO, D. (34)	DATE	20 NOV, 10:30	STATUS	WITNESS
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DS Where were you between two and four?

DO Down wet well 2 replacing a mechanical seal on the drainage pump. Permit 1144. You don't go into a confined space without a permit and a monitor, and the monitor talks to the control room the whole time you're down there. It's all logged, minute by minute. I was in at twelve past two and out at twenty to four.

DS And later?

DO Back down at twenty-five to six. Permit 1145. Out at twenty-five past. I came up into the middle of it.

DS You filed a grievance against Mr Sarn in August.

DO I did. He put me on nights for a month without consultation and I said so through the proper channel and I lost. That is the whole of it. I liked Aurelio. Losing a grievance to somebody is not a reason to — you're not seriously —

[Interviewee declines to complete the sentence.]

DS You signed the goods-receipt for the piezometer array in 2019.

[Long pause.]

DO I did.

DS Did you check it?

DO No.

DS Why not?

DO Because it was hour ten of a twelve, because Halloran put the sheet in front of me and said the Thennick lads have been and gone and it's all in, and because he is a chartered engineer and I am a fitter and that is how it works here. I signed for six instruments I never saw. Nobody has to tell me what that means. I have had six weeks to think about what that means.

DS Did anyone ever raise it with you?

DO Not once in five years. Not the regulator, not the auditors, nobody. And I'll tell you what I've realised since — if those instruments had ever been read by anyone who cared what the numbers meant, somebody would have noticed. So either nobody ever looked, or somebody was looking at numbers that came from somewhere else.

WET WELL 2 — ENTRIES OF 19 NOVEMBER

PERMIT 1144

Entrant	D. OKONKWO
Authorised by	A. SARN (Station Manager)
Entry	02:12:05
Exit	03:40:22
Task	DRAINAGE PUMP 2 — MECHANICAL SEAL
Standby attendant	NONE — REMOTE MONITORING

PERMIT 1145

Entrant	D. OKONKWO
Entry	05:35:41
Exit	06:25:30
Task	SEAL BEDDING-IN CHECK, RUN TEST

HOW THE MONITOR WORKS — AND WHY THIS IS NOT A SIGNATURE ON A SHEET

A personal atmospheric monitor is issued against the permit and worn on the entrant. It transmits **every fifteen seconds** to the control room for as long as it is below the wellhead — oxygen, hydrogen sulphide, methane, and a received-signal figure that falls away sharply with depth. The telemetry is what tells the surface that somebody is still down there and still breathing.

It cannot be left at the bottom of the well and walked away from. The signal profile of a stationary monitor and a worn one are not alike, and the unit alarms on thirty seconds of no motion.

TELEMETRY SUMMARY

PERMIT	TRANSMISSIONS EXPECTED	RECEIVED	GAPS	MOTION ALARMS
1144	354	354	NONE	NONE
1145	199	199	NONE	NONE

Unbroken worn-monitor telemetry from 02:12:05 to 03:40:22, and again from 05:35:41 to 06:25:30. Wet well 2 is beneath the turbine hall floor, reached by a single fixed ladder through one hatch.

CABINET C-14 AND THE ISOLATION THAT FAILED

CONDITION ON EXAMINATION

Cabinet door	OPEN, undamaged
F-5 isolator	OPEN — PADLOCK APPLIED, TAG SIGNED A.SARN
Proving unit	ON THE FLOOR, FUNCTIONAL, TESTED CORRECT
F-3 tie	CLOSED
Arc damage	MINOR, AT THE POINT OF CONTACT

LOCKOUT-TAGOUT, IN PLAIN TERMS

Before working on switchgear, you isolate the circuit at the breaker, apply **your own** padlock to the isolator, hang your tag on it, and then prove the circuit dead with a tester you have first proved on a live source. Nobody can remove your lock. Nobody can re-energise past it. It is a good procedure and it has kept people alive for eighty years.

It protects the circuit you locked. It says nothing whatever about a second circuit you did not know existed.

FINDING OF THIS REPORT

Mr Sarn did everything correctly.

He isolated feeder F-5. He applied his personal padlock and his signed tag. He proved the circuit dead with a tester that this department has since examined and found accurate. The cabinet was dead when he opened it and he had proved it so.

He was then killed at 06:03 by **feeder F-3**, a second supply to the same busbar, closed remotely from the control room at 06:02:14.

Question this department cannot answer. The as-built schedule for C-14 held in the control room — the drawing an engineer consults before isolating — shows this cabinet as **single-fed from F-5**. It does not show F-3. Whether that is an error in the drawing, or something else, is outside our competence and outside this report. Cairnhold engineering records hold the amendment history.

FILE F-4

SITE SECURITY & PERSONNEL

Three documents. They are yours. Nobody else may read them until the Conference ends.

DOC	TITLE
E-1	Door logs — control room and footbridge
E-1A	Roster, shift pattern & key issue register
C-5A	Credential practice at Ravensgate — witness note

Your brief. You speak for who was where, and for what a badge actually proves. The entire original finding rests on a credential. You hold the papers that say what a credential is worth at this site.

CONTROL ROOM & FOOTBRIDGE — 18-19 NOVEMBER

CONTROL ROOM DOOR — ALL EVENTS

TIMESTAMP	DIR	CREDENTIAL
18 NOV 21:57:02	IN	H.VEY
18 NOV 23:11:40	IN	I.BALLARD
19 NOV 01:12:18	OUT	I.BALLARD
19 NOV 01:50:12	IN	P.WRENN
19 NOV 01:58:40	OUT	P.WRENN
19 NOV 02:24:31	IN	A.SARN
19 NOV 02:29:55	OUT	A.SARN
— no control room door event of any kind, 02:29:55 → 05:44:03 —		
19 NOV 05:44:03	OUT	H.VEY
19 NOV 05:46:12	IN	H.VEY
19 NOV 06:10:44	IN	C.MBEKI

Between 02:29:55 and 05:44:03 — three hours and fourteen minutes — the control room door did not open. H. Vey was inside it, having entered at 21:57 and not left. No other person entered. Whatever was in that room during those three hours was accessible to one person and to nobody else.

Security note: the control room door is badge-controlled on entry and on egress. There is one door. The fire escape is alarmed and did not activate.

FOOTBRIDGE DOOR — DOWNSTREAM POWERHOUSE CROSSING

TIMESTAMP	DIR	CREDENTIAL
18 NOV 21:04:33	OUT	C.MBEKI (to powerhouse)
— no activation, 21:04:33 → 06:05:51 —		
19 NOV 06:05:51	IN	C.MBEKI (to main site)

The footbridge is the only route between the downstream powerhouse and the main site. The service tunnel was gated and padlocked as part of storm preparation on 18 November at 16:20 and was found still padlocked on 19 November. **C. Mbeki was on the far side of the river from 21:04 until 06:05.**

PERSONNEL — STORM WATCH, 18-19 NOVEMBER

NAME	ON DUTY	ASSIGNED STATION	CREDENTIAL NO.
SARN, A.	17:00 → (open)	Mobile — storm command	0001
VEY, H.	22:00 → 08:00	Control room, console 1	0004
BALLARD, I.	22:00 → 08:00	Control room, secondary	0007
OKONKWO, D.	18:00 → 06:00	Mechanical, mobile	0022
MBEKI, C.	21:00 → 07:00	Downstream powerhouse	0031
WRENN, P.	visitor	RDSI instrument van, crest	V-118

KEY ISSUE REGISTER — CONTROL ROOM

ISSUED TO	REASON	RETURNED
04 SEP C. MBEKI	Lock change — temporary override key	18 SEP — SIGNED IN BY A. SARN
—	No other physical key to the control room has been issued in three years. Access is by credential.	

CREDENTIAL POLICY — EXTRACT, SITE STANDING ORDERS §11

11.2	A credential card is personal and shall be carried on the person at all times while on site.
11.3	A credential card shall not be lent, left unattended, or used by any person other than the holder.
11.4	The system records the card. Responsibility for a recorded event rests with the holder.

Standing Orders are what the site says it does. Whether it does it is a separate question, and one this file has a note on.

WHAT A BADGE PROVES HERE

Compiled by the Review Unit from four statements. The original investigation did not take this point and did not need to, having reached its finding by another route.

- W-1

"Nobody wears the card on the crest in a gale. It's on a lanyard, it blows about, it catches. You leave it on the desk and you pick it up when you come back in. Everybody does it. Everybody has always done it."
- W-2

"Ines was the worst for it. She'd swipe in, drop the lanyard on the desk, and be off down the gallery. I've handed it back to her I don't know how many times."
- W-3

"There was a memo about it. There's a memo about everything."
- W-4

"You can't badge into the control room and then take your card out to the crest, because then you can't get back in. So you leave it. That's not laziness, that's the door."

DOCUMENTED	
Site memo SO-11 re-issued	MAR and AUG, same year
Informal warnings recorded, I. BALLARD, §11.2/11.3	TWO
Formal disciplinary action, any person, §11	NONE, EVER
Card readers requiring a second factor	NONE
Card readers with a camera	NONE

Note by the Review Unit. Standing Order 11.4 says responsibility for a recorded event rests with the holder. That is a rule about discipline. It is not a finding of fact about who was standing at the reader, and it cannot be used as one.

Where Ms Ballard's card actually was that night is a question of physical evidence. The scene property schedule will answer it. This file does not hold the property schedule.

FILE F-5

REGULATOR — RDSI

Three documents. They are yours. Nobody else may read them until the Conference ends.

DOC	TITLE
E-2	RDSI inspection — instrument gallery, junction box JB-7
E-2A	Contract RG-0419 — scope and certification history
C-4	Statement — P. Wrenn, Dam Safety & Instrumentation Officer

Your brief. You speak for the regulator — including for its failures. You hold the reason all of this happened, and one of the people holding it is your own officer. Your file is the only one that explains *why*. It says almost nothing about *who*.

JUNCTION BOX JB-7 — FOUNDATION PIEZOMETER ARRAY

INSPECTED

21 NOV

INSPECTOR

C. FALCONE, RDSI

OFFICER EXCLUDED

P. WRENN
(CONFLICT)

FINDING

Piezometers P-7 to P-12 do not exist.

Junction box JB-7, interior	EMPTY
Cabling installed under RG-0419	TERMINATES UNCONNECTED BEHIND THE BOX
Borehole collars P-7 to P-12	NOT PRESENT. NO DRILLING EVIDENCE.
Instruments recorded as installed 2019	6
Instruments actually present	0
Values reported against P-7 to P-12 since 2019	CONTINUOUS, PLAUSIBLE, COMPLETE

The array was never installed and has been reporting for five years. The values submitted to this Inspectorate quarterly since 2019 were generated by something other than an instrument in the ground.

Ms Ballard's observation on the night — that the reported values did not respond to reservoir level — is correct, and is the signature of synthetic data. A real foundation piezometer under a rising reservoir cannot fail to move.

CONSEQUENCE

The actual foundation pore pressures at Ravensgate are unknown and have been unknown for five years. The Inspectorate has issued a Section 10 direction. The station is operating under restriction pending a full drilling and instrumentation programme.

This is a matter of very considerable regulatory gravity independent of the two deaths, and the Inspectorate wishes it recorded that it is not a small thing that happened alongside a murder. It is the reason there was one.

CONTRACT RG-0419

TITLE	FOUNDATION INSTRUMENTATION RENEWAL & LEGACY FEEDER DECOMMISSIONING	CONTRACTOR	THENNICK INSTRUMENTATION LTD
LET	2019	VALUE	\$1.41 M

SCOPE — TWO PARTS

#	SCOPE	CERTIFIED COMPLETE	ACTUALLY DONE
A	Install foundation piezometer array P-7 to P-12, instrument gallery, with junction box JB-7 and telemetry	YES — 2019	NO (E-2)
B	Permanently decommission and physically remove legacy 11 kV feeder F-3, turbine hall	YES — 2019	NOT KNOWN TO THIS INSPECTORATE

NOTE BY THE INSPECTORATE, ADDED 12 JAN

Scope A was certified complete and was not done. Scope B was certified complete by the same signature on the same day under the same contract. **The Inspectorate has no basis to assume scope B was executed and every reason to doubt it.**

We note without comment that Mr Sarn is recorded as having been killed by feeder F-3.

CERTIFICATION & RECEIPT

Cairnhold certifying engineer, scopes A and B	HELD IN CAIRNHOLD ENGINEERING RECORDS — NOT SUPPLIED TO RDSI
Goods-receipt signatory, scope A	D. OKONKWO
RDSI acceptance of the 2019 data package	P. WRENN — DOCUMENT REVIEW ONLY, NO SITE VERIFICATION

RDSI procedure permits acceptance on document review where the certifying engineer is chartered. It is permitted. On this occasion it was catastrophic.

P. WRENN — DAM SAFETY & INSTRUMENTATION OFFICER, RDSI

INTERVIEWEE	WRENN, P. (61)	DATE	21 NOV, 09:00	STATUS	WITNESS
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DS Why were you on site?

PW Scheduled instrument inspection, booked in September. I'd have been away by seven if the hill hadn't come down on the road. I spent the night in the van with a laptop and a flask like a man half my age.

DS You went into the control room at ten to two.

PW For eight minutes, to ask Halloran whether he intended to pass water, because if he did I wanted to be logging while he did it. He said he would at half past. I went back to the van and I logged it.

DS Did you see Ms Ballard?

PW Not that night. She telephoned the van at about one, wanting to know whether I had the 2019 commissioning data for the foundation array, and I said it would be in the office in the morning.

DS Did she say why she wanted it?

PW She said the numbers were dead. Those were her words. "Piotr, the numbers are dead, they haven't moved in six hours and the reservoir's come up a third of a metre."

DS What did you say?

[Pause.]

PW I said instruments drift and we'd look at it Thursday.

DS You accepted the 2019 data package for that array.

PW I did.

DS Without a site verification.

PW Without a site verification. It is permitted where the certifying engineer is chartered and Halloran Vey is chartered. And I will tell you the true reason, because you will find it anyway and I would rather say it. The gallery is down forty-one steps and I was three weeks off a hip replacement and I did not want to go down them. That is the whole of my defence and it is not one.

DS You and Mr Vey worked together.

PW At Thennick. Fifteen years ago, for about two. He was good. I'd have said he was one of the better ones.

DS Where were you at six this morning?

PW On the satellite phone to my duty desk telling them we had a fatality, and they record those calls, and I would be obliged if you would go and listen to it, because a man is dead on a station I signed off and I am sixty-one years old and I would like somebody to check.